
Nordic RSE manuals

The Nordic-RSE team

Sep 24, 2026

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Warning: This page is a work in progress.

This is Nordic-RSE’s internal handbook: manuals, checklists, and templates for how we actually run the association, its board, its conferences, and its website. It’s written for people organizing or helping run things — board members, conference organizers, and anyone taking on a task for Nordic-RSE — rather than for the general public.

For that public-facing side — who we are, our events, our blog, how to join — see nordic-rse.org instead. This handbook is the “how do we actually do this” companion to that site.

These pages document past history, but they don’t dictate future. They are a starting point: feel free to be adventurous.

New here? Start with [onboarding.md](#).

NEW TEAM MEMBER ONBOARDING

1.1 Must know and do

The **Nordic Research Software Engineers** association (in short, Nordic-RSE) is a grass-root association that aims at providing a professional network to **Research Software Engineers** (RSE) in the Nordics and Baltics. While the term “RSE” is not as of yet of common use here, Nordic-RSE is currently a community for people who operate at the interface between research and digital technologies (software, computing, data). We operate on an inclusivity base: if you think that the above description is you, then you are welcome in our association!

See `community.md` for the association’s aims, and our [Code of Conduct](#), which applies to all our spaces.

1.1.1 Connect

- **Chat - Zulip:** <https://coderefinery.zulipchat.com> — our main communication platform, shared with the CodeRefinery community. This makes you part of the community.
 - introduce yourself in `#greetings>introductions`
 - lots of optional channels, check them out!
- **Weekly coffee break:** Thursdays at 9:00 Europe/Stockholm (10:00 Europe/Helsinki), same [Zoom link](#). Not a planning meeting — an informal chat and a great way to get to know who is around.
- **Bi-weekly meetings:** [notes and agenda](#), [Zoom link](#), every second Thursday at 13:00 Europe/Stockholm (starting 2025-08-21). These are our planning meetings — join if you would like to help with activities or shape the association’s future. Everybody welcome; you do not have to be a member of the association to join.
- **Mailing list:** [sign up here](#) — best way to stay in contact without interacting much. No need to be a member of the association to sign up.
- **Association membership:** [membership form](#) and [membership fee](#) — see [membership.md](#) for how to join and what it enables.

1.2 Extras

Now you know the basics, here are a few more things you can look into if time :)

1.2.1 Events

- Events calendar: <https://nordic-rse.org/events/#calendar> (add to your calendars)
- Events specific channels on Zulip chat

1.2.2 News

- Mastodon: https://fosstodon.org/@nordic_rse
- LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/company/nordic-rse/>
- BlueSky: <https://bsky.app/profile/nordic-rse.bsky.social>
- Blog: <https://nordic-rse.org/blog/>

1.2.3 Collections and sources

See [website.md](#) for the website's source and how to contribute to it.

We collect all of our graphics in [our materials GitHub repository](#).

All presentations, posters and data is in our Nordic-RSE associations google drive, ask the board members for access in case you need it.

1.2.4 Accounts

If you're joining the organizing team, please get yourself an account on the following platforms:

- Zulip
- GitHub
- HackMD

On GitHub we have an organization that you will be added to to have access to few private repositories and be able to merge pull requests etc. On HackMD we have a team that you will be added to to have write access to some team notes.

1.3 Thank you!

No matter what you choose to do, we are happy to have you! Nordic-RSE lives through its people and community!

NORDIC-RSE MEMBERSHIP AND WHAT IT ENABLES

For who can join, how to join, the membership fee, and why to become a member, see [nordic-rse.org's Get involved](#) and [membership fee](#) pages — those are the public-facing, up-to-date versions to point a prospective member to. This page covers the organizer/board-facing side: the governance mechanics behind membership, and how organizations can support us.

2.1 Organizational support

Organizations can also support Nordic-RSE, for example by:

- sponsoring specific activities or services, locally or Nordic-wide, or
- letting staff contribute to Nordic-RSE on work time.

Reach out if you have other ideas for how your organization could help.

2.2 Rights as a member

- **Voting:** each member has one vote at association meetings — see [annual_meeting.md](#) for the full voting/quorum mechanics.
- **Annual/general assembly:** members are invited to participate — see [annual_meeting.md](#) for timing and practicalities.
- **Board membership:** members can be elected to the board at the annual meeting — see [onboarding_board.md](#) for board composition and how it works.

2.3 Losing membership

The board can remove a member who acts against the association's purpose, violates the code of conduct, or fails to pay their fee. Members have the right to know the reason for their removal and to express objections in writing.

2.4 Welcome e-mail template

Send this after someone fills in the [membership form](#) (which itself only shows an on-screen “Thank you for registering in the Nordic RSE group!” message, and collects Name, Title, Email, Country/City of Residence, and Affiliation — no e-mail is sent automatically).

```
Subject: Welcome to Nordic-RSE!

Hi <name>,

Thanks for your interest in becoming a member of the Nordic-RSE association! To
become a full member, please pay
the membership fee (10€/year) if you haven't already – see how at
https://nordic-rse.org/about/membership-fee.

Once that's done, you're a full member, which means:
- you get a vote at our annual meeting,
- you can be elected to the board, and
- you're helping fund the community and our activities.

A few other ways to get involved, if you haven't already:
- Join our Zulip chat: https://coderefinery.zulipchat.com
- Sign up to the mailing list: https://forms.gle/paPBnvsw5GAXUzBN6
- Come to our weekly coffee break or biweekly meeting – see
  https://nordic-rse.org/join/ for times.

Welcome aboard!

<sender name>, on behalf of the Nordic-RSE board
```

TODO: confirm who is responsible for sending this (e.g. secretary@nordic-rse.org) and whether it should be sent immediately per submission or batched.

NORDIC-RSE WEBSITE

We work in the open as much as possible, and our website is our main outward-facing material.

3.1 Source and hosting

nordic-rse.org is a static site built with [Zola](https://zola.readthedocs.io/) from markdown files, hosted on GitHub Pages. The source is at [nordic-rse/nordic-rse.github.io](https://github.com/nordic-rse/nordic-rse.github.io).

We don't track visitors or use cookies on the website (see the [privacy notice](#)).

3.2 Content structure

Pages live under `content/`, organized by URL path, e.g. `content/about/`, `content/blog/`, `content/events/`, `content/communities/`, `content/join/`, `content/resources/`. Each event gets its own dated folder under `content/events/`. Static assets (images, CSS, JS) are under `static/`, and Zola/Tera page templates are under `templates/`.

There are also GitHub issue templates for common cases, e.g. a website issue or a seminar series event, under `.github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE/` in the source repo.

3.3 Writing blog posts

Blog posts are named `content/blog/YYYY-MM-DD-slug.md`.

TODO: what kind of content we are looking for in blog posts (e.g. conference/event reports, member spotlights, technical write-ups, community news), and any expectations on length, tone, or review before publishing.

3.3.1 Use of AI

No fully AI-generated posts. AI tools can help with drafting or summarizing, but a human needs to stay in the loop: read, fact-check, and rewrite in your own voice before publishing. Making a post genuinely engaging — the personal angle, the specific details, the humor, what actually mattered to you about the event or topic — is something AI can't do for you; that part is on the human author.

3.4 Calendar

The `events calendar` is a separate system from the main website: `nordic-rse/calendar` turns `calendars/*.yaml` files (one per calendar: `NordicRSE`, `community`, `conferences`, `other`, `series`) into `.ics` files via `yaml2ics`, and publishes them to GitHub Pages via its own GitHub Actions workflow. The `.ics` feeds are also embedded on the main site (e.g. the Google Calendar embed on the `events page`).

To add or edit an event, edit the relevant `calendars/*.yaml` file in that repository and open a pull request.

3.5 Domain and DNS

TODO: who manages the `nordic-rse.org` domain registration and DNS records. GitHub Pages is configured to serve the custom domain via a CNAME set in the deploy workflow, but the domain registrar/DNS provider and who has access to it isn't documented here yet.

3.6 Branding and style assets

Logos (current and old), stickers, and social-media card templates are collected in `nordic-rse/nordic-rse-materials`, under `graphics/`. Everything there is CC-BY licensed.

3.7 Previewing changes locally

Install `Zola`, then from the repository root:

```
zola serve
```

3.8 Contribution guidelines

- Anyone can suggest changes via `issues`, or work on them directly with a fork and pull request.
- If you want more involvement in the website work, ask the board to be added to the `nordic-rse` GitHub organization.
- Code and templates are MIT licensed; page content is `CC-BY`, same as the rest of Nordic-RSE's material — by contributing content you agree to license it this way.
- TODO: content/style conventions (writing style, markdown conventions, image formats/sizes, alt text and other accessibility expectations).
- TODO: commit message or PR conventions, if any.

3.9 Publishing process

Opening a pull request automatically builds a preview of the site, linked in a comment on the PR (`preview/PR<number>/`); the preview is removed once the PR is merged or closed. Pushing or merging to `main` triggers a production build and deploy.

TODO: who is expected/allowed to review and merge pull requests, and whether a review is required before merging.

3.10 Access

All board members are part of the Nordic-RSE GitHub organization. Others can be added upon request.

CONTRIBUTING TO THE NORDIC-RSE MANUALS

This repo is built into a documentation site with [Sphinx](#), published to <https://nordic-rse.github.io/nrse-manuals/>.

Sphinx is a documentation generator: it takes source files (here, Markdown via the [MyST](#) parser) and builds them into a navigable site (HTML, plus PDF/epub in our case). It's configured via `conf.py` in this repo. See the [Sphinx documentation](#) for more, or the [MyST syntax guide](#) for the Markdown extensions it supports (e.g. the `{toctree}` and admonition blocks used in this repo).

4.1 index.md vs README.md

`index.md` is a symlink to `README.md` — they are the same file on disk, not two copies. Sphinx needs a file named `index.md` as its root page (`master_doc = 'index'` in `conf.py`), while GitHub renders `README.md` as the repo's landing page; the symlink lets one file serve both without duplicating content. `conf.py` excludes `README.md` from the Sphinx build itself, so it isn't processed twice. In practice: just edit `README.md` (or `index.md`, it's the same file), and both stay in sync automatically.

4.2 Adding a new page

1. Add a new `.md` file at the repo root.
2. Add it to the relevant `{toctree}` block in `README.md` — a page not listed in a `toctree` won't appear in the built site's navigation, even though the file exists. (This has bitten us before — several pages in this repo were created without being added to a `toctree`.)

4.3 Building locally

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
make html
```

Open `_build/html/index.html` in a browser. `make dirhtml` produces the same output but matches the structure used for the live site more closely.

`make gh-pages` (used by CI) additionally builds the single-page HTML, PDF, and epub versions, which requires a full LaTeX install (`make gh-pages-dependencies`) — you generally don't need this for local editing.

4.3.1 Without make

`make html` is just a wrapper around `sphinx-build`; you can call it directly instead:

```
sphinx-build -b html . _build/html
```

(`-b` selects the builder, e.g. `dirhtml` or `epub` instead of `html`.) Or, since `requirements.txt` also installs `sphinx-autobuild`, get a live-reloading dev server:

```
sphinx-autobuild . _build/html
```

4.4 CI checks

- **Sphinx build** (`.github/workflows/sphinx.yml`): builds the site on every push/PR, and deploys to gh-pages on push to main.
- **Spellcheck** (`.github/workflows/spellcheck.yml`): runs `misspell` on every push and fails the build on errors. Run `bin/misspell -error *` locally if you want to check before pushing.

4.5 Conventions used in this repo

- Prefer linking to the canonical page over repeating its content — several pages here link to each other (or out to nordic-rse.org) rather than duplicating text, to avoid the copies drifting out of sync.
- Public-facing content (who we are, how to join, event info) belongs on nordic-rse.org; this repo is the organizer/board-facing “how we actually do this” side — see the note at the top of `README.md`.
- Where we don’t actually know how something is done in practice, say so with a `TODO`: note rather than guessing or leaving it blank.

NORDIC-RSE CONFERENCE ORGANIZATION HANDBOOK

This document is WIP

See also: [conference-roles.md](#) (what each role entails), [conference-timeline.md](#) (when to do what), [conference-checklist.md](#) (checklist of tasks), [conference-tools-templates.md](#) (tools and templates for websites, e-mails, and forms), [conference-funding.md](#) (funders, packages, and contracts), [conference-av.md](#) (AV setup and presenting logistics), and [conference-session-chair-guide.md](#) (a step-by-step guide for session chairs).

5.1 Purpose

The Nordic-RSE conference brings together researchers, engineers, developers, and other digital experts to talk about topics that are often overlooked at classical academic conferences: not the results of research, but the software tools and practices that underlie it. The aim is to build a community and a network around the practice of software development in research — one that matters more as research keeps depending more on software.

This purpose text is reused near-verbatim across our conference websites (e.g. the [2024](#) and [2026](#) “What is it?” sections) — reuse and adapt it when announcing a new conference.

5.2 Committees and roles

See [conference-roles.md](#) for what each role entails.

- Programme committee
- Local committee
- Main organizer
- CoC committee
- Session chairs
- Funding/sponsorship committee
- Finance chair

5.3 Code of Conduct

Every Nordic-RSE conference has its own Code of Conduct page and a companion “Code of Conduct information for organizers” page — see [coc-conference.md](#) (copied from the 2024 Code of Conduct page) and [coc-info-for-organizers.md](#) as the templates to copy for a new event. These are separate from Nordic-RSE’s general Code of Conduct, which covers the community as a whole.

As an organizer, you should know:

- **Warnings:** any organizer or CoC committee member can issue a verbal warning to a participant who violates the policy. Report it to secretary@nordic-rse.org as soon as practical, including who, when, what happened, and the circumstances.
- **Taking reports:** record what’s reported, reassure the reporter they’re being taken seriously, don’t pressure them for details they’re reluctant to give, and respect their privacy.
- **Expulsion:** organizers or the CoC committee can expel a participant; see the organizer info page above for guidelines on when this is warranted.
- **Public statements:** don’t make public statements about an individual’s behavior during or after the conference.

The CoC committee (see above) is the point of contact for enforcement decisions and reports.

Some venues (e.g. a university or conference center) may come with their own Code of Conduct. In that case, it may make sense to follow the host’s CoC instead of, or alongside, our own — check with the venue and decide with the CoC committee which applies.

5.4 EDIA considerations

- balanced organizer team
- balanced keynote speakers
- balanced panels

5.5 Documents

- One planning document with source of truth, updated in meetings
 - Conference specific timeline with actual dates and deadlines
 - Plan of execution: what happens when and who needs to be where

5.6 Funding

See [conference-funding.md](#) for who to approach, when, suggested funding packages, and contract templates.

5.7 Budgeting

TODO: Add all points that should be in budget and link to sheets template

Note: Keep the budget updated at all times, and make clearly visible what is an estimate and what is the real cost and their currency.

5.8 Communications

All communications should go through the shared secretary@nordic-rse.org e-mail address. Use the scheduling function.

5.9 Further reading and other resources

- SSI short guide on inclusive event planning: <https://www.software.ac.uk/guide/inclusive-event-planning-start-finish>
- [nordic-rse/conference_utilities](#): utilities for organizing conferences and events, e.g. generating visa invitation letters

CONFERENCE ROLES

Short description of each organizing role listed in [conference.md](#). One person can hold more than one role, especially for a smaller conference.

6.1 Main organizer / Conference chair

Overall lead for the conference. Keeps the planning document (see [conference.md](#)) up to date, is the main point of contact (including via secretary@nordic-rse.org), coordinates the other committees, and tracks the timeline against [conference-timeline.md](#) and [conference-checklist.md](#). Also owns overall accountability for the EDIA considerations in [conference.md](#), e.g. a balanced organizer team.

By default, the Main organizer also covers funding/sponsorship and finance (see below) — for a larger conference, these can be split out into a dedicated Funding/sponsorship committee and Finance chair instead.

6.2 Local committee

Handles on-the-ground logistics at the conference location: booking the venue and rooms, catering, accommodation suggestions, and coordinating with local hosts (e.g. a local RSE team, university, or e-Infra provider — see [conference-funding.md](#)). Also in charge of recruiting, onboarding, and coordinating on-site volunteers (see [conference.md](#) for helper onboarding).

6.3 Programme committee

Runs the scientific/technical program: the call for contributions, reviewing and selecting submissions, inviting and coordinating keynote speakers, and building the schedule. In practice also owns the EDIA considerations for keynote speakers and panels — see [conference.md](#).

6.4 CoC committee

Point of contact for Code of Conduct enforcement: receiving and handling reports, deciding on warnings or expulsions, and generally making sure the event stays safe and welcoming. See [coc-conference.md](#) and [coc-info-for-organizers.md](#) for the full policy and how to act on a report.

6.5 Session chairs

On-the-day role: introduce speakers, keep sessions on time, and moderate Q&A. Session chairs don't need to be part of the organizing team — they can be recruited from among the attendees. See [conference-session-chair-guide.md](#) for a full step-by-step guide, suitable for a first-time chair.

6.6 Possible separate functions

For a larger conference, these can be split out as their own roles; for a smaller one, fold them into the committees above.

6.7 Funding/sponsorship committee

Owns [conference-funding.md](#) end to end: identifying and approaching funders, negotiating funding packages, handling contracts and invoicing, and making sure sponsor benefits (logo placement, talk slots, acknowledgments, etc.) actually get delivered before and during the conference.

6.8 Finance chair

Tracks the conference's live budget (see [conference.md](#)) day to day: recording estimated vs. actual costs and income, and processing reimbursements. This is about tracking and managing conference spend, not the association's bookkeeping — for that, stay in close contact with the Nordic-RSE board's treasurer (see [onboarding_board.md](#)) for actual payments, invoicing, and reconciling the conference budget with the association's accounts.

6.8.1 Outreach

Grows visibility and attendance: spreading the call for contributions and registration beyond our own channels, contacting other RSE communities/networks, and encouraging colleagues and collaborators to submit or attend.

6.8.2 Remote

Handles virtual/hybrid participation: streaming and recording talks, monitoring and relaying remote Q&A, and making sure remote attendees can actually follow and take part, not just watch. See [conference-av.md](#) for the AV setup this relies on.

6.8.3 Website

Maintains the conference-specific pages on nordic-rse.org (dates, location, program, registration links, practical info) — see [conference-tools-templates.md](#) for what a conference page should cover.

6.8.4 Community/socials

Runs the conference's social media posts (see [conference-tools-templates.md](#)) and on-site community-building activities, e.g. informal get-togethers, coffee breaks, and other ways for attendees to get to know each other outside of talks.

TIMELINE

7.1 ~Year before

- Find location
- Set dates
- Book rooms
- Build organizing team
- Send “save the date”

7.2 ~10 months before

- Set roles for organizing team
- Create website
- Check about accommodation
- Check about catering options
- Decide on ticket price
- Sponsor outreach
- Start consistent meetings
- Think about keynote speakers

7.3 xx months before

- Open call for contributions
- Open registration

7.4 xx months before

- Close call for contributions
- Send acceptance, instructions, confirmation

7.5 xx weeks before

- Send author instructions
- Close registration
- Confirm catering

TOOLS AND TEMPLATES

8.1 Website

- Dates
- Location
- What is it
- Who is it for
- How to contribute
- How to participate, cost, what is included
- How to arrive
- Where to stay
- What to do around
- Who to contact in case of questions
- How to join organization team

8.2 E-mails that can be prepared

- Confirmation of registration
- Participant info
- After registration deadline
- Few days before conference
- Author info
- Separate for different contributions
- Acceptance letter
- Invitation
- Wrap-up e-mail

See [nordic-rse/conference_utilities](#) for a script that generates a visa invitation letter as a PDF.

8.3 Registration form

- dietary restrictions
- which days to attend
- suggestion for commonly organized discussion session
- Greetings to organizers
- Special needs?
- Privacy policy
- Photos agreement

8.4 Contribution form

- title
- abstract
- format (priority)
- author presenting
- co-authors
- Note on sharing contribution
- Preference on day/time
- Other comments

8.5 Social media posts

- Save the date + location
- Keynote announcements
- Registration open
- Call for contributions open
- Call for contributions soon closing
- Registrations soon closing
- Conference start
- In between conference
- Conference close
- In between: thanks to sponsors

8.6 Examples

A-Z document example : https://hackmd.io/@nordic-rse/nrsecon25_az

8.7 Registration and contribution collection

- NeIC Indico

8.8 Payment handling

- tickettaylor?

CHECKLIST OF WHAT NEEDS TO BE DONE

This document is WIP

See [conference-av.md](#) for AV (audio/visual) setup and presenting logistics.

- ☐ Set dates
- ☐ Create website
- ☐ Setup registration
- ☐ Setup payment system
- ☐ Book rooms
- ☐ Send newsletter
- ☐ Post on social media
- ☐ Post on chat
- ☐ Suggest hotels
- ☐ Suggest travel
- ☐ Suggest sightseeing
- ☐ Call for contributions
- ☐ Decide on possible contribution types, think venue and time
- ☐ Decide on deadlines, think catering, scheduling
- ☐ Send participant info
- ☐ Prepare intro/outro presentation
- ☐ Prepare something for community building
- ☐ Nametags, think personalization
- ☐ Speaker gifts
- ☐ Organizer gifts
- ☐ Goodies for participants / Sticker table
- ☐ Collection process for presentations
- ☐ Set up AV (see [conference-av.md](#))
- ☐ Decide topic or session topics
- ☐ Feedback form?

- [] ...

CONFERENCE FUNDING

This document is WIP — the packages and contract section below are a suggested starting point, not settled policy. Adapt with the board/organizing team and update this doc once agreed.

10.1 Who to approach

- Software Sustainability Institute
- Society for RSE in UK, via events fund
- Local companies — think of a policy first: what kind of companies do we want associated with Nordic-RSE, and are there any we'd rather not take money from?
- NeIC
- Local RSE team
- Local e-Infra provider

Funding doesn't have to be cash: past conferences have also been funded in kind, e.g. a university providing the venue and local support for free (as Aalto Scientific Computing did for the [2024 conference](#)).

10.2 When to approach

Start sponsor outreach around 10 months before the conference (see [conference-timeline.md](#)), once dates, location, and the organizing team are set. Many companies and institutes plan sponsorship budgets a year ahead, so reaching out early gives them a better chance of saying yes.

10.3 Suggested funding packages

A tiered package makes it easy for a funder to see what they get for what they give. Suggested starting point (amounts are placeholders — adjust to local costs and currency):

10.3.1 Supporter (~300–500€ or in-kind equivalent)

- Logo on the conference website and on-site signage
- Thanks in the opening/closing remarks and on social media

10.3.2 Partner (~1000–2000€ or in-kind equivalent)

- Everything in Supporter, plus:
- Logo on lanyards/name badges or printed materials
- A lightning talk slot, or a table at the venue
- 1-2 complimentary registrations for their staff

10.3.3 Champion (~3000€+ or in-kind equivalent, e.g. covering the venue)

- Everything in Partner, plus:
- Named sponsorship of a specific item (e.g. the conference dinner, coffee breaks, or travel grants)
- Logo featured prominently (e.g. on the main stage backdrop)
- Acknowledgment in the post-conference blog report

10.4 Contract templates

TODO: we don't have a reusable sponsorship contract/agreement template yet. When drafting one, it should cover at least:

- what the funder provides (amount/in-kind contribution, and by when)
- what Nordic-RSE provides in return (per the package above)
- logo/branding usage rights and any approval steps
- invoicing details (Nordic Research Software Engineers ry; see the [membership fee page](#) for our SEPA bank details) and payment timeline
- what happens if the conference is cancelled or postponed

CONFERENCE AV (AUDIO/VISUAL)

11.1 Presenting

Have presenters connect and share their screen via Zoom, even for a fully in-person, non-hybrid event. This sidesteps the usual mess of HDMI/USB-C/DisplayPort adapter compatibility between many different laptops — presenters just join a Zoom call and share their screen, which is then displayed via a laptop connected to the room's projector. It also gives you an easy option to record or stream the session if you decide you want to, even if the event wasn't originally planned as hybrid.

TODO: agree on the exact workflow — does everyone present from the same Zoom call running on a laptop connected to the projector, or does each presenter join individually from their own laptop in the room?

11.2 Collecting contributions in advance

TODO: how we ask presenters to submit their slides ahead of time, in what format, by when, and where they're collected/stored (e.g. shared with the Programme committee). No documented process yet.

11.3 Recording

TODO: whether we record talks, who's responsible for recording, and where recordings get published afterwards (we do have a [Nordic-RSE YouTube channel](#), linked from the [resources page](#)).

11.4 Streaming for hybrid/remote participation

See the Remote function in [conference-roles.md](#). Zoom (as above) is a natural fit for streaming to remote participants, since it's already our default video tool for other meetings.

TODO: standard workflow for how remote Q&A gets relayed back to the room.

11.5 Local AV support

Get contact details for the venue's local AV/IT support well before the conference, and confirm how to reach them (phone, on-site desk, etc.) during the event days. If possible, arrange for someone from local AV support to be present on-site on the conference day(s), so a technical problem can be fixed quickly instead of eating into the schedule.

11.6 Equipment checklist

- Laptop adapters/dongles for common connectors (HDMI, USB-C, DisplayPort) — presenters' laptops vary
- Spare presentation clicker/remote, with spare batteries
- Backup laptop with slides pre-loaded, in case a presenter's own laptop or Zoom connection fails
- Microphone(s) suited to the room size, plus spares/backup batteries
- Extension cords/power strips near the podium
- Test the full setup (laptop → projector → audio → Zoom) before the session starts, ideally the day before

11.7 Backup plan

TODO: what to do if AV fails mid-session (backup room laptop, printed slides, etc.) — no documented fallback process yet.

SESSION CHAIR GUIDE

A practical, step-by-step guide for chairing a session, written so that someone who has never done it before can follow it. See [conference-roles.md](#) for how the role fits among the others.

12.1 Before your session

- Get the schedule for your session: speaker names, affiliations, talk titles, and how much time each talk (and Q&A) gets.
- If possible, greet your speakers before the session starts, confirm how to pronounce their name, and agree on a time-signal system with each of them (see Timekeeping below).
- Check that each speaker's laptop/screen-share is working before the session starts, not after they're already up — see [conference-av.md](#) for the presenting setup (e.g. Zoom screen-share) and who to contact if something isn't working.
- Know who your local AV contact is and how to reach them during the session (see [conference-av.md](#)).
- If the session is hybrid/streamed, know how remote questions will reach you (see [conference-av.md](#)).

12.2 Introducing a speaker

Keep it short:

1. Speaker's name and affiliation.
2. The talk's title.
3. Optionally, one sentence on why it's interesting or how it connects to the conference themes.

Avoid summarizing the talk itself — that's the speaker's job.

12.3 Timekeeping

Running over time on one talk eats into every talk after it, so this is one of the chair's most important jobs.

- Agree on a signal system with the speaker beforehand, e.g. holding up a hand or a sign at 5 minutes, 1 minute, and time's up.
- Start the talk on time even if the room isn't full yet — waiting for stragglers punishes people who showed up on time.
- If a speaker runs over, it's OK to interrupt firmly but politely: “We're out of time — let's take one more question and continue the conversation during the break.”

TODO: confirm if Nordic-RSE has a standard/preferred signal system or timer tool chairs should use.

12.4 Moderating Q&A

- Invite questions clearly: “We have a few minutes for questions.”
- If nobody raises a hand right away, it's fine to have a question of your own ready to break the silence.
- If a question runs long or turns into a comment/mini-talk, politely redirect: “Could you get to your question?” or “Let's continue this during the break.”
- If the session is recorded or streamed, repeat or summarize the question before the speaker answers, so remote/recording audiences can follow.
- If a hybrid/remote question comes in via chat, relay it to the speaker yourself.
- If a question or comment violates the *Code of Conduct*, stop it and, if needed, involve the CoC committee afterward — see *coc-info-for-organizers.md*.

12.5 If something goes wrong

- **AV/technical issue:** contact local AV support (see *conference-av.md*) and keep the audience informed rather than standing in silence — buy time with a quick informal question to the speaker or the room if needed.
- **Speaker no-show or cancellation:** let the audience know, and either extend the break, move the next talk up, or open the floor for informal discussion.
- **Running behind schedule overall:** flag it to the main organizer/programme committee at the next break rather than trying to fix it alone mid-session.

12.6 After your session

- Thank the speakers again.
- Make sure the room is ready for whatever comes next (next session, break, etc.).
- Pass on anything worth knowing (e.g. a recurring AV issue, a question you had to cut off) to the main organizer or the next chair.

CODE OF CONDUCT FOR IN PERSON CONFERENCES

This code of conduct is copied and adapted from the example policy at the [Geek Feminism wiki](#), created by the Ada Initiative and other volunteers (CC-0 license). The procedure for reporting harassment has been adapted from the Ada Initiative's guide titled "[workshop anti-harassment/Responding to Reports](#)".

We value the participation of each stakeholder and want our members and participants to our events to have an enjoyable and fulfilling experience. Accordingly, all members and participants are expected to show respect and courtesy to other members and participants through all communication channels.

To make clear what is expected, all Nordic-RSE members as well as participants, speakers, exhibitors, organisers and volunteers at Nordic-RSE events are required to conform to the following code of conduct. Organisers will enforce this code throughout the event.

13.1 Summary

We are dedicated to providing a harassment-free experience for everyone. We do not tolerate harassment in any form.

All communication should be appropriate for a professional audience including people of many different backgrounds.

Be kind to others. Do not insult or put down others.

Behave professionally. Remember that harassment, unprofessional remarks and messages, and exclusionary jokes are not appropriate in Nordic-RSE.

Conference participants violating these rules may be sanctioned or expelled from the conference without a refund at the discretion of the conference organizers. Members of Nordic-RSE may have their membership revoked by the board.

Thank you for making the Nordic-RSE conference a welcoming and friendly event for all.

13.2 Clarifications

Harassment includes offensive communication related to gender, sexual orientation, disability, physical appearance, body size, race, religion, sexual images in public spaces, deliberate intimidation, stalking, following, harassing photography or recording, sustained disruption of talks or other events, inappropriate physical contact, and unwelcome sexual attention.

Participants asked to stop any harassing behaviour are expected to comply immediately.

Be careful in the words that you choose. Remember that words can be offensive to those around you. Offensive jokes are not acceptable in the Nordic-RSE. Excessive swearing is not appropriate.

13.3 Enforcement

If a participant at a Nordic-RSE event violates this code of conduct, organisers may take any action they deem appropriate, including a warning the offender, removing them from the workshop with no refund, or banning the offender from future Nordic-RSE events.

If a member of Nordic-RSE engages in behaviour that violates this code of conduct, the board of the association at the recommendation of the Code of Conduct committee may take any action they deem appropriate, including warning the offender or revoking their membership without refund of the membership fee.

13.4 Reporting

If someone makes you or anyone else feel unsafe or unwelcome, please report it as soon as possible. Harassment and other code of conduct violations reduce the value of our event for everyone. We want you to be happy at our event. People like you make our event a better place.

You can make a report either personally or anonymously.

13.4.1 Anonymous Report

You can make [this online form](#).

We can't follow up an anonymous report with you directly, but we will fully investigate it and take whatever action is necessary to prevent a recurrence.

13.4.2 Personal Report

You can make a personal report by:

- Contacting any member of the Code of Conduct committee
- Contacting any conference organizer
- Contacting any member of the [Nordic-RSE board](#)

When taking a personal report, organizers will ensure you are safe and cannot be overheard. They may involve other event staff to ensure your report is managed properly. Once safe, we'll ask you to tell us about what happened. This can be upsetting, but we'll handle it as respectfully as possible, and you can bring someone to support you. You won't be asked to confront anyone and we won't tell anyone who you are.

Our team will be happy to help you contact hotel/venue security, local law enforcement, local support services, provide escorts, or otherwise assist you to feel safe for the duration of the event. We value your attendance.

13.5 Contact Information

In an emergency call 112. This includes medical, police and rescue services.

Organizers: secretary@nordic-rse.org

TODO: update per-event contact information (venue help line, local emergency/non-emergency numbers, local support services) for each conference — these are venue- and country-specific and need to be filled in per event.

CODE OF CONDUCT INFORMATION FOR ORGANIZERS

This code of conduct is copied and adapted from the example policy at the [Geek Feminism wiki](#), created by the Ada Initiative and other volunteers (CC-0 license). The procedure for reporting harassment has been adapted from the Ada Initiative's guide titled "[workshop anti-harassment/Responding to Reports](#)".

Please read this before organizing a Nordic-RSE event. This page describes how we enforce security and the code of conduct in a Nordic-RSE event.

14.1 Warnings

Any member of conference organizer or code of conduct committee member can issue a verbal warning to a participant whose behavior violates the conference's anti-harassment policy.

Warnings should be reported to secretary@nordic-rse.org as soon as practical. This ensures that other organizers know about the warning and creates a record.

The report should include:

- Identifying information (name/badge number) of the participant
- The time you issued the warning
- The behavior that was in violation
- The approximate time of the behavior (if different than the time of warning)
- The circumstances surrounding the incident
- Your identity
- Other people involved in the incident

14.2 Presentations

Presentations or similar events should not be stopped for one-time gaffes or minor problems, although a member of conference staff should speak to the presenter afterward. However, staff should take immediate action to politely and calmly stop any presentation or event that repeatedly or seriously violates the anti-harassment policy. For example, simply say "I'm sorry, this presentation cannot be continued at the present time" with no further explanation.

14.3 Taking reports

When taking a report from someone experiencing harassment you should record what they say and reassure them they are being taken seriously, but avoid making specific promises about what actions the organizers will take. Ask for any other information if the reporter has not volunteered it (such as time, place) but do not pressure them to provide it if they are reluctant. Even if the report lacks important details such as the identity of the person taking the harassing actions, it should still be recorded and passed along to the appropriate staff member(s). If the reporter desires it, arrange for an escort by conference staff or a trusted person, contact a friend, and contact local law enforcement. Do not pressure the reporter to take any action if they do not want to do it. Respect the reporter's privacy by not sharing unnecessary details with others, especially individuals who were not involved with the situation or non-staff members.

The report should include:

- Identifying information (name/badge number) of the participant
- The time you issued the warning
- The behavior that was in violation
- The approximate time of the behavior (if different than the time of warning)
- The circumstances surrounding the incident
- Your identity
- Other people involved in the incident

14.4 Expulsion

A participant may be expelled by the decision of the conference organizers or code of conduct committee member, for whatever reasons they deem sufficient. However, here are some general guidelines for when a participant should be expelled:

- A [third] offense resulting in a warning from staff
- Continuing to harass after any “No” or “Stop” instruction
- A pattern of harassing behavior, with or without warnings
- A single serious offense (e.g., punching or groping someone)
- A single obviously intentional offense (e.g., taking up-skirt photos)

Venue security and local authorities should be contacted when appropriate.

Phone number for Aalto help line: contact details removed

14.5 Public statements

As a general rule, conference staff should not make any public statements about the behavior of individual people during or after the conference.

In general, consult with other staff members when possible but act when necessary.

ONBOARDING FOR NORDIC-RSE MEMBERS OF THE BOARD

Welcome, new board member!

Link to statutes: <https://nordic-rse.org/about/governance/>

15.1 Rights and responsibilities

The board handles the association's affairs between annual meetings. In practice this is a small group of volunteers taking care of the essentials: budgeting, paperwork, and making sure the association stays on track in support of the broader goals of the community.

- **Composition:** a chair, 3–7 other regular members, and 0–8 deputies, all appointed at the annual meeting. From amongst its members, the board selects a vice chair, and additionally a secretary, a treasurer, and any other necessary functionaries.
- **Term:** the board's term of office runs from one annual meeting to the next.
- **Signing for the association:** the association's name can be signed by the chair, vice chair, secretary, or treasurer, each separately.
- **Financial year:** 1 January – 31 December.

15.2 Access

As a board member you have the right to access:

- Private Zulip channel
- HackMD Nordic RSE board organization
- Secretary e-mail account

The secretary e-mail account is handled by delegation. You will get your own `firstname@nordic-rse.org` address which in turn can access the secretary account for reading and writing e-mails on behalf of the association.

15.3 Meetings

The board convenes when the board considers it necessary, or when at least half of the board members request it — in practice, usually about twice a year.

- **Quorum:** at least half of the board members, including the chair and vice chair, must be present.
- **Decision making:** see below.

15.4 Annual meeting

The board is elected, and discharged, at the annual meeting. See [annual_meeting.md](#) and [annual_meeting_template.md](#) for the agenda, timing, and the practical checklist we use to run it.

15.5 Decision making

Board votes are resolved by strict majority. In the event of a tie, the chair has the casting vote — except in elections, where ties are broken by lot.

For decision making at the annual/association meeting, see [annual_meeting.md](#).

NORDIC-RSE ASSOCIATION ANNUAL MEETING

Link to statutes: <https://nordic-rse.org/about/governance/>

16.1 Practicalities (per the statutes)

- Held annually, January–March.
- The board must invite members by e-mail no later than seven days before the meeting.
- The statutes allow members to attend in person, or remotely by mail, online, or other technical tools — in practice, our meeting is held remotely.
- The meeting is held in English.
- Each member has one vote; decisions are the proposals that receive more than half the vote, unless the statutes say otherwise (statute amendments and dissolution require a three-quarters (3/4) majority vote).

16.2 Timeline

- Reminder to mailing list and chat to become members and pay their fee
- Save the date
- Reach out about new board members
- Agenda
- Annual Meeting
- Notes
- Website updates

16.3 Meeting parts

For the full agenda, invitation text, and meeting notes, use *annual_meeting_template.md* — it follows the statutory agenda (Section 10) point by point.

Additional considerations when preparing the voting of the new board:

- Country considerations
- EDI considerations

ANNUAL MEETING TEMPLATES

17.1 Invitation

We would like to invite you to the Nordic RSE associations annual meeting on xx at xx CEST. The meeting replaces the biweekly community meeting and is expected to take around 1.5h.

In the meeting we will briefly present the association activities and financial statements for xx. The meeting is also to make important decisions regarding the association, such as selecting the board and deciding the size of the membership fee for xx.

Voting in the meeting is restricted to members. If you pay your membership fee before xx, we will count you as a member in the meeting.

See the full agenda at xx. You will also find details for joining the remote meeting there.

Regards, The Nordic RSE board

17.2 Agenda and notes

General info

- **Video connection details:**
 - Zoom invite link: xx
- **Contact:**
- **Date and time:** xx
- **This page:** xx
- **If you cannot edit this document:** Add your HackMD username below and we will add you

17.2.1 Participants

- xx

17.2.2 Summary schedule

1. opening the meeting
2. choosing a chair, secretary, two auditors of the minutes and when necessary two vote counters
3. determining quorum and legality of the meeting
4. approving the agenda for the meeting
5. the associations financial statements, annual report and the statements of the auditors are presented
6. deciding on approving the financial statements and the discharging of the board and other accountable persons
7. establishing the action plan, the revenue and expenditure estimate and the amount of the membership and membership fees
8. choosing the chair of the board and other board members
9. choosing one or two auditors and deputy auditors (auditor = toiminnantarkastaja or tilintarkastaja depending on the size of the budget)
10. discussing other issues mentioned in the invitation to the meeting

17.2.3 Opening the meeting

- Opened at xx
- Note that prefilled items are suggestions from the board (and may be altered in the meeting)

Choosing chair

- Chair: xx
- Note taker: xx

Choosing votes counter

- Voting procedure: anyone can make proposals, vote arises only if there is opposition
 - Note names here

Choosing 2 auditors of meeting minutes

- Need volunteers, easy job: Read and sign the meeting minutes after the meeting. Either print, sign and scan, or sign electronically.
 - Note names here

17.2.4 Determining legality and quorum

- Invitation was sent no less than 7 days before the meeting by email. The meeting is in accordance to the statutes and has quorum.

17.2.5 Accepting the agenda

- This meeting follows the agenda for the annual meeting presented in the statutes.

17.2.6 The associations financial statements, annual report and the statements of the auditors are presented

- Annual report:
 - Management:
 - * Day to day affairs mainly managed by the biweekly meeting
 - * Domain registration fee sponsored by xx
 - Events:
 - * Advent of Code event?
 - * Unconference
 - * Weekly coffee break
 - * Biweekly community meeting
 - Other activities:
 - * Write here

17.2.7 Deciding on approving the financial statements and the discharging of the board and other accountable persons

- The current members of the board and other accountable persons are discharged from duty. This releases them from accountability.
- Either by unanimous agreement or by majority vote.

17.2.8 Establishing the action plan, the revenue and expenditure estimate and the amount of the membership and membership fees

- Suggested membership fee: xx eur
- Action plan:
 - In person workshop / unconference
 - Seminar series?
 - Advent of Code event?
 - Unconference

- Weekly coffee break
 - Biweekly community meeting
- Budget

17.2.9 Electing the chair and vice chair and members of the board

- Need
 - secretary
 - chair and vice chair
 - 1-5 more members
 - possibly alternate members for each full member
- Call for volunteersSuggestions / Volunteers:
 - Chair: Name here
 - Vice chair: Name here
 - Names here
- result of the vote: confirmed unanimously

17.2.10 Electing auditors

- choosing one or two auditors and deputy auditors
- Volunteers:
 - Name here

17.2.11 Discussing other issues mentioned in the invitation to the meeting

- Notes here

17.2.12 Closing the meeting

- closed xx

17.2.13 Signatures

Download this guide as [single-page HTML](#), [pdf](#), or [epub](#).

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